

first significant work, the one-act opera *La vida breve* (Life Is Short), completed in 1904.

Falla aimed to establish his place in the wider European contemporary music scene and in 1907 moved to Paris, where he associated with composers such as Claude Debussy and Maurice Ravel. His output through his seven years in France was slight (a handful of songs and short piano pieces) but his musical impetus was germinating. When World War I broke out in 1914 he returned to live with his parents in Madrid, and a period of rich creativity followed.

Music of passion

Despite his measured manner, Falla began to produce music that was flamboyant and passionate, as in *El amor brujo* (Love, the Magician), a ballet commissioned by the renowned flamenco dancer Pastora Imperio (see [box](#)). First performed in 1915, this piece included the dramatic Ritual Fire Dance, which became one of Falla's most enduringly popular pieces.